HD Point, report, Landscape, Nigeria, 2026-10-30

AI in Nollywood: how Nigerian filmmakers are using AI tools, and the questions they face

Key figures

Figure	Value	Basis	Claim
Festival debut submissions	490 submissions	**Verified**	c7

What was reported

1. Nigerian filmmakers and digital creators are using AI to cut costs, expand storytelling possibilities and compete globally, industry insiders told Forbes Africa. **Verified** c1
2. In March 2026, a YouTube-backed workshop in Lagos introduced filmmakers including Biodun Stephen and Omoni Oboli to Flow, an AI filmmaking tool developed by Google. **Verified** c2
3. Filmmakers at the workshop said AI could help them visualise scenes before filming, speed up conceptualisation and simulate scenes that would be expensive or difficult to shoot. **Company says** c3
4. Actor and producer Omoni Oboli says she has used AI tools to generate story ideas, animate videos and create promotional materials. **Company says** c4
5. Travel and lifestyle creator Tayo Aina says he has used generative AI to recreate historical moments in his documentary-style videos when archival footage was unavailable. **Company says** c5
6. For the film Eshugbayi Eleko, AI was used to create establishing shots and briefly reconstruct Lagos as it looked in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, with some AI-generated sequences lasting only a few seconds, a filmmaker told NewsCrackers NG. **Company says** c6
7. The Naija Artificial Intelligence Film Festival, founded by Obinna Okerekeocha, received 490 submissions for its debut, according to TechCabal. **Verified** c7
8. Okerekeocha says he wants to train thousands of African AI filmmakers over the next five years and support tools trained on local languages, voices and cultures. **Company says** c8
9. Makemation, produced by Nigerian AI developer turned filmmaker Toyosi Akerele-Ogunsiji, was released in Nigerian cinemas in 2025 and has toured international festivals and universities. **Verified** c9

10. The producers of Makemation describe AI as both a storytelling subject and part of the production workflow, combining generative AI systems with live-action filmmaking. **Verified** c10

11. NewsCrackers NG says transparency about AI use could become increasingly important in Nollywood as audiences encounter more AI-generated images, voices and scenes. **Company says** c11

How well sourced is this?

5 of 11 claims are supported by an independent source. 6 come from the company itself and have not been independently checked.

Source	Claims	Basis
https://www.forbesafrica.com/current-affairs/2026/03/11/tell-stories-otherwise-not-told-how-nigerias-creatives-turn-to-ai-tools-to-boost-film-production	c1, c4, c5	Verified, Company says
https://www.premiumtimesng.com/news/more-news/862915-youtube-introduces-nigerian-filmmakers-to-ai-powered-filmmaking-tool.html	c2, c3	Verified, Company says
https://newscrackersng.com/ai-in-nollywood-between-faster-filmmaking-the-fight-to-preserve-nigerian-authenticity/	c6, c11	Company says
https://techcabal.com/2025/09/10/ai-in-nollywood-naiff/	c7, c8	Verified, Company says
https://theconversation.com/makemation-a-nollywood-movie-that-shows-ai-in-action-in-africa-277693	c9	Verified
https://theafricanmirror.africa/lifestyle/arts-and-entertainment/african-filmmakers-are-experimenting-with-ai-as-hollywood-debates-its-risks/	c10	Verified

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